

Figure 7: The *multitail* command with the output of 3 files in 3 columns

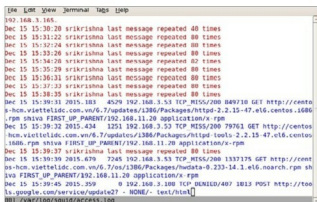


Figure 8: The *multitail* command with the *merge* and *colour* options

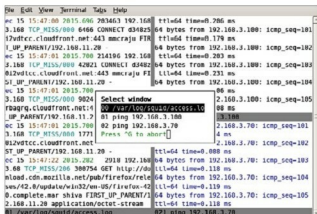


Figure 9: The *multitail* command with the *-b* option

The syntax for *multitail* is as follows:

```
Smultitail /var/log/squid/access.log /var/log/messages
```

You can have the two files displayed in two columns with the `-s` option, as follows:

```
$multitail -s 2 /var/log/squid/access.log /var/log/messages
```

You can easily monitor more than three files with this command by adding more file names in the command.

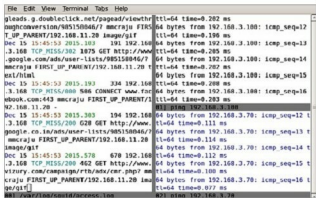


Figure 10: The *multitail* command with the *-f* option to view output of commands

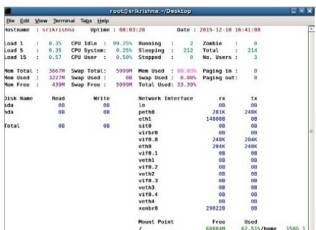


Figure 11: The *saider* command output

It allows you to view two different files in different colours with the *ci* option. The *-I* option can be used to merge the output of the two files.

```
$multitail -ci blue /var/log/squid/access.log -ci red -I /  
var/log/messages
```

The command is also interactive and allows you to scroll through the files, and choose a file to view from the list of open files by typing *b*.

You can view the outputs of the commands instead of a file with the `-l` option.

```
multitail /var/log/squid3/access.log -l "ping
192.168.3.100" -l "ping 192.168.3.70"
```

You can even use a wild card for a file name. The most recent file matching the wild card is opened, and the moment this is done, the lines of the new files are displayed instead of the lines of the older file. There are numerous other options and features that users can refer to in the manual.